

PSY307 PERSONALITY PSYCHOLOGY

Course Syllabus (CRN: [16188](#))



MW 12:00 – 1:20 PM

HEDCO 220,

University of Oregon

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Personality psychology is the scientific study of how and why people differ from one another: why some of us are anxious while others stay calm under pressure, why some are generous while others are cold and calculating, why some are always open to try something new while others prefer to play it safe. Personality psychologists seek to understand the traits, motivations, abilities, emotions, and beliefs that make each person unique and to explain how those differences shape our lives. In this course, I hope you gain a better understanding of who you are and what forces have shaped you. The course is divided into three units. The first unit explores foundational questions about personality, including how it is defined, measured, and judged, and how it develops and changes across the lifespan. The second unit examines the biological basis of personality and explores cognitive and affective aspects such as cognitive styles, intelligence, creativity, self-control, motivation, emotionality, and happiness. The third unit considers the influence that culture has on shaping personality, examines differences in worldviews, moral beliefs, and values, and explores the impact that personality has on our relationships and mental and physical health.

OFFICE HOURS

Instructor

Sarah Dimakis, Ph.D.

sdimakis@uoregon.edu

WR 1:30 – 3:00 PM, or by appointment

Straub 437

Graduate Teaching Fellow

Murat Kezer, M.S.

TBD

Graduate Teaching Fellow

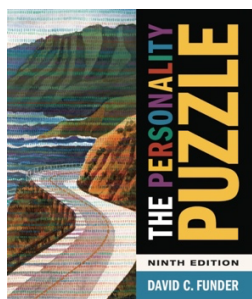
Taren Rohovit, M.S.

TBD

CONTACTING US

Please don't hesitate to contact us if you have any questions or concerns! When you e-mail us, please add PSY307 in the subject line (e.g., "PSY307 exam question"). I teach three classes per term, so this really helps me keep things organized and answer your question quickly. Each student has been assigned a GTF for this course, so you know exactly who to contact when you need assistance. You can find your assigned GTF by checking the "office hours" page on Canvas. However, if your GTF's office hours don't fit in your schedule, you're welcome to drop by on any office hours that do! When you e-mail us, you can expect to receive a response within 2 business days, typically earlier. If we do not respond to your email within 2 business days, please resend it (making sure PSY307 is in the title) because we may have not received it.

COURSE MATERIALS



The textbook for the course is **The Personality Puzzle** by David Funder, ninth edition, although earlier editions are perfectly acceptable. All other readings or videos will be uploaded to Canvas. To get the most of lecture, I recommend reading the assigned readings *prior to the class they are associated with*. Additionally, this course uses **iClicker for attendance and in-class polling**. You can use either an iClicker remote or download the iClicker app on your mobile device or computer to participate. Using the app or a used remote may require you to purchase a subscription to iClicker if you don't currently have one. However, you can opt out of using iClicker by signing a paper up front each class. See the "participation" section for more details about how to set up your iClicker. If financial concerns are prohibiting you from accessing course materials, I urge you to meet with me and/or apply for a [textbook subsidy](#) through UO's Basic Needs Program.



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

This course will help you develop skills that are valuable beyond university, such as introspection, critical thinking, and effective communication. You will also be working to improve skills that are necessary to be a consumer and/or producer of research, like reading about, critically evaluating, and communicating about scientific findings. Upon completion of this course, you will be able to (1) describe and identify important theories and research findings in personality psychology, (2) understand how personality psychologists use experimental methods to draw conclusions about how people differ from one another, and (3) apply these personality psychology theories and findings to experiences in your life.

ESTIMATED STUDENT WORKLOAD

Upon completion of this course, you will earn 4 credits toward your degree. A four-credit course from the University of Oregon is equivalent to 120 hours of work across the term, or 12 hours per week for 10 weeks. You will spend about 30 hours in class (3 hours a week), about 40 hours reading or watching supplemental material (4 hours a week), and the remaining 50 hours (about 5 hours per week) working on outside of class assignments (i.e., discussion board posts, quizzes, and studying for exams).

COURSE MODALITY

This is an in-person course. Unlike asynchronous online/ASYNC WEB courses, we will meet during scheduled class meeting times in *HEDCO 220*, which is located near the cross section of 18th and Alder St. I will accommodate absences as described in the Participation section below. If you need additional flexibility, UO encourages you to consider ASYNC WEB courses. If you need accommodation related to a medical or other disability, you can request those by working with the Accessible Education Center.

ASSESSMENTS & GRADING

Your learning will be assessed through multiple choice and free-response exams (60% of your grade), personal reflections about your personality (35% of your grade), and participation in in-class polls (5% of your grade).

Assignment	Grade Weight
Unit Exams (x3)	60%
Personal Reflections (x7)	35%
iClicker Participation	5%

The following grid provides the letter grade associated with each percent. If you are within .5% of a grade category, your grade will be rounded up if you have 100% in the Participation grade category. A student may be assigned an “A+” for a final grade if they demonstrate exemplary understanding of the course material across all assessments (> 97% on all three grade categories).

A 93-100%	B 83-86.99%	C 73-76.99%	D 63-66.99%
A- 90-92.99%	B- 80-82.99%	C- 70-72.99%	D- 60-62.99%
B+ 87-89.99%	C+ 77-79.99%	D+ 67-69.99%	F 59.99% or below

UNIT EXAMS

There will be three exams, each covering material since the last exam. Each exam has 30 multiple choice questions and five short answer questions that may ask you to interpret data, apply course concepts to examples, or generate examples based on a theory or model. You may bring a 3" by 5" notecard with handwritten or typed notes to use during the exam (front and back), food/ drink (try not to spill it on your exam though), and headphones if you want to listen to music or sounds (e.g., white or brown noise, café background noise, ocean sounds). A study guide will be posted at least one week before each exam, which will contain **all topics** that could be on the exam. There may be topics covered only in readings or videos (not in class), but those topics will be clearly specified on the study guide. Notecards will be provided in class the week before each exam, or you are welcome to use your own. To review a graded exam, please notify the instructor or your GTF at least **two days prior** to the office hours when you plan to review it so that we can pull your exam from the stack. Some students prefer to go over each incorrect answer, while others like to go over their exam quietly and then ask questions when applicable. Please let us know which you prefer so that we can best help you!

REFLECTIONS

The purpose of the reflection assignments is to use concepts and tools from personality psychology to gain a deeper insight into your personality and everyday experiences. For example, you may be asked to complete a personality assessment and analyze the results or apply a personality theory or finding to your life. Reflections are due on Canvas **Sundays at 11:59pm** and graded excellent (5/5)/ pass (4/5)/ fail (0/5). Excellent reflections will demonstrate evidence of critical thinking, self-awareness, and an ability to accurately integrate psychological concepts into your analysis. Each reflection should be no more than 500 words and written clearly and concisely and free of major spelling or grammatical errors.

PARTICIPATION & ABSENCES

By the second week of class, you are required to bring iClickers to class to track your attendance and answer in-class polls. Prior to week 2, you'll need to (1) [make an iClicker student account](#), (2) [join our class](#), (3) and, if you have a physical remote, add your remote ID in your "profile." You can use either an iClicker remote or download the [iClicker app](#) on your mobile device or computer to participate. Your participation grade will be based on the percent of classes you participate in, not on the accuracy of your responses. **You may miss 3 classes without penalty.** Missing classes due to a religious observance, specific AEC accommodation, military deployment, or a University-sponsored event with signed documentation do not count toward your three absences. Difficult or complex situations that may impact attendance will occur for many of us during a term. This **reason-neutral** policy means that absences are available both for students who *do* want to reach out about their experiences and students who *do not*. If you are feeling ill, please stay home and use one of your three absences. I made the participation policy with this in mind, so please use your absences with care, so they're there for you if you need them.

ACCESS & ACCOMMODATIONS

The University of Oregon and I are dedicated to fostering inclusive, equitable, and accessible learning environments for all students. The [Accessible Education Center](#) (AEC) assists students with disabilities in reducing barriers in the educational experience. You may be eligible for accommodations for a variety of disabilities – apparent disabilities, such as a mobility or physical disability, or non-apparent disabilities, such as chronic illnesses or psychological disabilities. If you have or think you have a disability and experience academic barriers, please contact the Accessible Education Center (Location: 360 Oregon Hall; 541-346-1155; uoaec@uoregon.edu) to discuss appropriate accommodations or support. The details of your disability will be kept confidential with the AEC, and you are not expected to share this information with others. However, I invite you to discuss any approved accommodations or access needs at any time with me.

LATE WORK & MAKE-UP EXAMS

To make it easy to remember, assignments in this course are always due on **Sundays at 11:59pm**. In the case that you fall ill or otherwise cannot complete your work on time, I have built flexibility into the course in the following ways:

- All students have one free, no-questions-asked extension to turn in an assignment late **for any reason**, no questions asked. If you wish to use your extension, *comment on the assignment "I am using my one free extension"* when you submit it to Canvas. No need to e-mail me that you're using your extension unless you can't find a place to comment!
- If an assignment is turned in **more than 24 hours** after the due date, the assignment will be marked off 5% (max score is now 95%). If 48 hours has passed, the assignment will be marked off 10% (max score is now 90%). Anything after 72 hours will receive the max late penalty of 15% off (max score is now 85%).
- If you need to miss an exam, you can sign up to take a make-up exam via the link on Canvas. Please only sign up for one *if you really need one (e.g., illness, family emergency)*, as spots are limited and first come/first serve!

ACCOMMODATIONS FOR RELIGIOUS OBSERVANCES

The University of Oregon respects the right of all students to observe their religious holidays, and will make reasonable accommodations, upon request, for these observances. If you need to be absent from a class period this term because of a religious obligation or observance, please fill out the [Student Religious Accommodation Request fillable PDF form](#) and send it to me within the first weeks of the course so we can make arrangements in advance.

CLASSROOM COMMUNITY EXPECTATIONS

It's imperative to a healthy learning environment that we treat each other with respect and commit to learning from each other. This requires us (1) to refrain from passing judgment on others (and ourselves) for making mistakes or not yet knowing something, (2) to be cognizant of how much we are speaking and adjust accordingly to allow the class to hear from different perspectives, and (3) to disagree with others respectfully by providing empirical or experiential evidence rather than attacking their character. Continued enrollment in the course indicates agreement that you will enthusiastically abide by these guidelines.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE USE

You are permitted (and encouraged) to use AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Grammarly) to assist with studying for an exam, idea generation, or refining your writing. However, keep in mind that AI can provide inaccurate or overly simplistic responses, and you are responsible for the accuracy and quality of the work that you submit. If you choose to use these tools, then **they must not prevent you from achieving the learning goals of the course**. Relying on AI to think for you – such as copying an answer directly from ChatGPT and submitting it as your own -- will hinder your learning and therefore is considered a violation of the academic integrity policy for this course.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Any form of academic dishonesty, including getting outside help on assignments, plagiarizing of any kind, improper use of AI (as outlined in the policy above), or lying to the instructor or a GTF will not be tolerated in this class. You are permitted (and encouraged) to work and study with other students on class assignments, but the work you submit *must be your own* and therefore should not be a direct copy of another student's work. Please complete any assignments labeled "quiz" or "exam" completely on your own. If you have questions about what is considered academic dishonesty for this course, or if you are struggling with your coursework to the point that you feel you have no choice but to violate our academic integrity policy, please reach out to the instructor, the AEC, and/ or the dean of students. If I detect any academic dishonesty, I will follow the procedure to handle misconduct as outlined by the University, meaning that instances of suspected cheating or plagiarizing will be reported to the University.

INTERESTED IN GRADUATE SCHOOL IN PSYCHOLOGY?

Please don't hesitate to come to office hours if you'd like to talk to me about graduate school in psychology. I am a recent (Summer 2024) graduate of UO's PhD program in Social and Personality Psychology and am always happy to share my experience. I can't speak too much to graduate school in mental health fields (more so to research psychology), but I do know the basics and can connect you with resources.

YOUR WELLBEING

During your college experience, you may feel overwhelmed or stressed, experience anxiety or depression, struggle with relationships, or just need help navigating challenges in your life. If you're facing such challenges, you don't need to handle them on your own--there's help and support on campus. Getting help is a courageous thing to do—for yourself and those you care about. [University Health Services](#) helps students cope with difficult emotions and life stressors. If you need general resources on coping with stress or want to talk with another student who has been in the same place as you, visit the Duck Nest (located in the EMU on the ground floor) and get help from one of the specially trained Peer Wellness Advocates. University Counseling Services (UCS) has a team of dedicated staff members to support you with your concerns, many of whom can provide identity-based support. All clinical services are free and confidential. Find out more at counseling.uoregon.edu or by calling 541-346-3227 (anytime UCS is closed, the After-Hours Support and Crisis Line is available by calling this same number).

BASIC NEEDS

Being able to meet your basic needs is foundational to your success as a student. If you are having difficulty affording food, don't have a stable, safe place to live, or are struggling to meet another need, visit the [UO Basic Needs Resource](#) page for information on how to get support. They have information food, housing, healthcare, childcare, transportation, technology, finances (including emergency funds), and legal support. If your need is urgent, please contact the Care and Advocacy Program by calling 541-346-3216, filling out the [Community Care and Support form](#), or by [scheduling an appointment](#) with an advocate.

ACADEMIC DISRUPTION DUE TO CAMPUS EMERGENCY

In the event of a campus emergency that disrupts academic activities, course requirements, deadlines, and grading percentages are subject to change. Information about changes in this course will be communicated as soon as possible by email, and on Canvas. If we are not able to meet face-to-face, students should immediately log onto Canvas and read any announcements and/or access alternative assignments. Students are also expected to continue coursework as outlined in this syllabus or other instructions on Canvas.

INCLEMENT WEATHER

It is generally expected that class will meet unless the University is officially closed for inclement weather. If it becomes necessary to cancel class while the University remains open, this will be announced on Canvas and by email. Updates on inclement weather and closure are also communicated as described on the [Inclement Weather](#) webpage.

REPORTING OBLIGATIONS

I am a designated reporter. For information about my reporting obligations as an employee, please see [Employee Reporting Obligations](#) on the Office of Investigations and Civil Rights Compliance (OICRC) website. Students experiencing sex- or gender-based discrimination, harassment or violence should call the 24-7 hotline 541-346-SAFE [7244] or visit safe.uoregon.edu for help. Students experiencing all forms of prohibited discrimination or harassment may contact the Dean of Students Office at 541-346-3216 or the non-confidential Title IX Coordinator/OICRC at 541-346-3123 to request information and resources. Students are not required to participate in an investigation to receive support, including requesting academic supportive measures. Additional resources are available at investigations.uoregon.edu/how-get-support. I am also a mandatory reporter of child abuse. Please find more information at [Mandatory Reporting of Child Abuse and Neglect](#).

PSY307 PERSONALITY PSYCHOLOGY

FALL 2025 Course Schedule

WEEK	DATE	TOPIC	READING	DUE
1	M Sept. 29	Course introduction	Syllabus	Register your iClicker
	W Oct. 1	Measuring personality	Chapter 1-2	
	S Oct. 5			
2	M Oct. 6	Personality traits vs. types	Ch. 5, pp. 128 – 158	Reflection 1
	W Oct. 8	The big five personality traits	Ch. 5, pp. 159 - 166	
	S Oct. 12			
3	M Oct. 13	Personality judgment	Ch. 4, pp. 106 - 126	Reflection 2
	W Oct. 15	Personality stability & change	Ch. 6	
	S Oct. 19			
4	M Oct. 20	EXAM 1		
	W Oct. 22	Personality and the brain	Ch. 7	
	F Oct. 26			
5	M Oct. 27	Personality inheritance	Ch. 8	Reflection 3
	W Oct. 29	Cognitive and thinking styles		
	S Nov. 2			
6	M Nov. 3	Intelligence and creativity	DeYoung (2011)	Reflection 4
	W Nov. 5	Motivation and self-control	Ch. 13 pp. 420 – 438	
	S Nov. 9			
7	M Nov. 10	Emotion and happiness	Ch. 13, pp. 441 - 457	Reflection 5
	W Nov. 12	EXAM 2		
	S Nov. 16			
8	M Nov. 17	Beliefs about the world	Clifton et al. (2019)	Reflection 6
	W Nov. 19	Morals, virtues, and values	Schwartz (2012)	
	S Nov. 23			
9	M Nov. 24	Cultural differences	Ch. 12	
	W Nov. 26	Generational differences*		
	S Nov. 30			
10	M Dec. 1	Personality and relationships	Ch. 15, pp. 486 - 511	Reflection 7
	W Dec. 3	Personality and health	Ch. 16	
	S Dec. 7			
Finals	W Dec. 10 @ 10:15am			EXAM 3

***Note:** This is the day before thanksgiving, so I'll post a zoom link for class in case you are travelling! You should be able to still get the attendance points on the iClicker app or by e-mailing me that you attended on zoom.